

Teacher card

Maps symbols and grid references / LAUNCH_A2_W01

Outcome: Use maps OS symbols and grid references.

Evidence to retain: F: map check and location/pattern question.

Forty minute route

Arrival 4 min; starter 3; model 6; shared task 7; check 2; independent 12; review 3; exit 3.
Pause time is flexible.

Preparation

Choose one independent route. Print the evidence and shared cards, required visual or data sheet, route worksheet and exit. The organiser is one separate A4 page. Keep answers with staff.

Use school fieldwork arrangements. No pupil names or photographs of identifiable strangers are needed. Indoor observation is valid when accurately labelled. OS Explorer abbreviations: Sch = school, PO = post office, FB = footbridge. The separate practice map uses its own teaching key.

Access and regulation

Pre-teach terminology and model evidence use. Chunk sources and data; provide an initial frame, then reduce it. Maintain normal access arrangements. Extend by weighing limitations, alternative explanations and evidence quality. Adults support access and evidence selection without supplying answers.

Offer a predictable start, private response and agreed pause. No cold calling or forced personal disclosure. Rejoin at one clearly named next step. Keep teen-appropriate examples and the same learning goal across response modes.

Use sensitive content warnings where relevant. Do not ask for family details or personal experiences.

Assessment

Use questioning and the exit response to decide the next step. Record the learner's individual contribution and the access support used.

UAS: no approved unit code is supplied. Match the learner's evidence to the centre-selected unit and exact criteria before submission. This pack makes no automatic award claim.

Model and answers

Read these pages before teaching. Hide the model during independent assessment.

Question: What area does a four-figure reference locate?

Evidence: Practice grid: read eastings across first, then northings up. Four figures identify a whole square. The park is in 1122.

Think aloud: A whole grid square.

Check: Why consult the actual map key? Symbol meanings and map detail depend on the map series; our practice symbols are labelled teaching symbols.

Arrival answers

1. A place where people live
2. A place where people live
3. A whole grid square.
4. Symbol meanings and map detail depend on the map series; our practice symbols are labelled teaching symbols.

Shared activity reasoning

Exit responses

What area does a four-figure reference locate? A whole grid square.

Why consult the actual map key? Symbol meanings and map detail depend on the map series; our practice symbols are labelled teaching symbols.

Teaching and evidence record

Supplied scheme of work teaching sequence: Model map conventions; practise symbols/direction/grid references; finish with an independent map check.

Look for

F: map check and location/pattern question.

Accept accurate equivalents, including speech or exact scribing. Check the concept and use of evidence rather than length or handwriting. Record access support separately from content prompting.

BUILD: a concrete example with a reason or demonstrated action. GROW: explain or compare with a relevant detail. LAUNCH: connect evidence and reasoning; use a limitation when the outcome requires it. Keep RE responses non-GCSE.

Media

Original captioned teaching model made for this pack. It demonstrates the supplied reasoning; it is not historical footage, survivor testimony or a documentary. The full transcript and factual source credits are included.

Use manual steps for a calm pace. The silent MP4 has visible captions and a matching text transcript. External archive media is optional and should be previewed before class.

Source credits

OpenStreetMap Middlesbrough <https://www.openstreetmap.org/#map=15/54.5750/-1.2350>

OpenStreetMap Helmsley <https://www.openstreetmap.org/#map=15/54.2460/-1.0560>

Ordnance Survey grid references

<https://osmaps.com/discover/guides/beginners-guide-to-grid-references/>

Official OS Explorer symbol flashcards

<https://www.ordnancesurvey.co.uk/documents/resources/25k-map-symbol-flashcards.pdf>

Source access was checked on 19 September 2026. Restricted links are listed in Sources_and_checks.html; a restriction here is not proof that the page is dead. Offline teaching material remains available.